

Facility Security Minimum Standards

Facility safety and security measures, whether for offices (O) or residences (R), are important as these are locations where staff and assets congregate and offer a focused and static target for hostile persons and groups. Facility protection is fundamental for effective security risk management. The following factors should be considered as part of the facility selection rationale:

- Proximity to high-value terrorist targets
- Proximity to areas known to be a focus of rallies, demonstrations and civil disorder
- Access to evacuation routes and the ability to access international airports
- The distance from offices to cleared hotels and expatriate staff residences

The following checklist acts as a useful *aide memoire* for managers involved in facility security.

O	R	Security Standards and Considerations
☐	☐	Security Staff: Facility security may involve the provision of facility guards and shift leaders. It is important that the right levels of security staff are selected to meet the needs of access control, patrolling, lock and key security and emergency response.
☐	☐	Security Escorts: Security personnel may escort visitors within the building and ensure they are monitored and arrive and depart from their visit areas.
☐	☐	Security Structures: The management team must strike the right balance between a reasonable security profile and a robust structural security plan which delays, detects, and prevents unauthorized intruders from gaining access to a site.
☐	☐	Perimeter Security: Perimeter security may be either a physical or psychological barrier and provides a clearly marked demarcation between public and non-public areas. Perimeter security measures should reflect the local environmental conditions, as well as the security profile.
☐	☐	Access Control: Access control points are typically the weakest point within a facility security plan, as they permit entry for vehicles and pedestrians. The threat of persons seeking to enter, or force entry, into the site should be evaluated and adequate access control measures should be put into effect to restrict entry.
☐	☐	Lost Keys: Locks for keys that have been lost should be replaced immediately to ensure that locks and facilities cannot be compromised.
☐	☐	Searching: The searching of people and vehicles, whether by blanket policy or spot checking, is often required within higher risk environments, both upon entry and exit, to ensure no unauthorized items are brought into, or removed from, a facility. This can be a cultural, status and gender sensitive issue.

Safety, Security and Emergency Management System

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☐ ☐ **Doors:** Doors should be strengthened within higher risk environments to provide a robust barrier between staff and those seeking unauthorized access.

☐ ☐ **Windows:** Management and staff should consider the value of having windows barred on the bottom levels of a building to prevent unauthorized intrusion. Large windows facing streets present fragmentation hazards should explosions.

☐ ☐ **Blast Film (Windows):** Within environments where explosive hazards are a risk then management teams should consider having windows fitted with blast film to reduce fragmentation risks.

☐ ☐ **Safe Havens:** A Safe Haven is a room or area which provides temporary or long-term security and safety from humanmade risks within a building (or other structure) for program staff. Such areas or rooms may be strengthened to provide adequate protection.

☐ ☐ **Security Technologies:** The use of CCTV, Intrusion Detection Systems (IDS) and badging control measures can increase security measures while reducing profile and manpower levels. A sensible balance of technologies and manpower resourcing should be sought.

☐ ☐ **Security Lighting:** Security lighting may be used to deter or detect intruders, although it often raises the profile of a location. Both benefits and drawbacks of security lighting should be considered.

☐ ☐ **Security Protocols:** Security protocols for a facility are required to ensure that both guards and occupants adhere to practices which support sensible security measures.

☐ ☐ **Information Security:** A policy on information security of areas, offices, cabinets, desks, and assets should be articulated to protect sensitive or confidential information.

☐ ☐ **Fire Safety:** Facilities should have fire alarms and fire safety equipment to identify potential fire hazards and allow staff to extinguish fires.

☐ ☐ **Medical:** Facilities should have first aid equipment to deal with injuries occurring on site. Medical treatment points should be visibly designated.

☐ ☐ **Muster Points:** Emergency muster points both within the building, on the grounds and external to the grounds should be defined, communicated and drilled.

☐ ☐ **Guards:** Guards may be provided shelter from the elements if manning access control points and the grounds, as well as be provided rest areas in the building. If armed, then an “unloading bay” should be provided to safely unload weapons.

